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Write your Way to Study Abroad

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Founder - WiseUp

Session 1 of 5

AGENDA FOR THE DAY

1. Let’s build a community
2. Setup for success
3. Understand the study abroad process
4. Guide to resources

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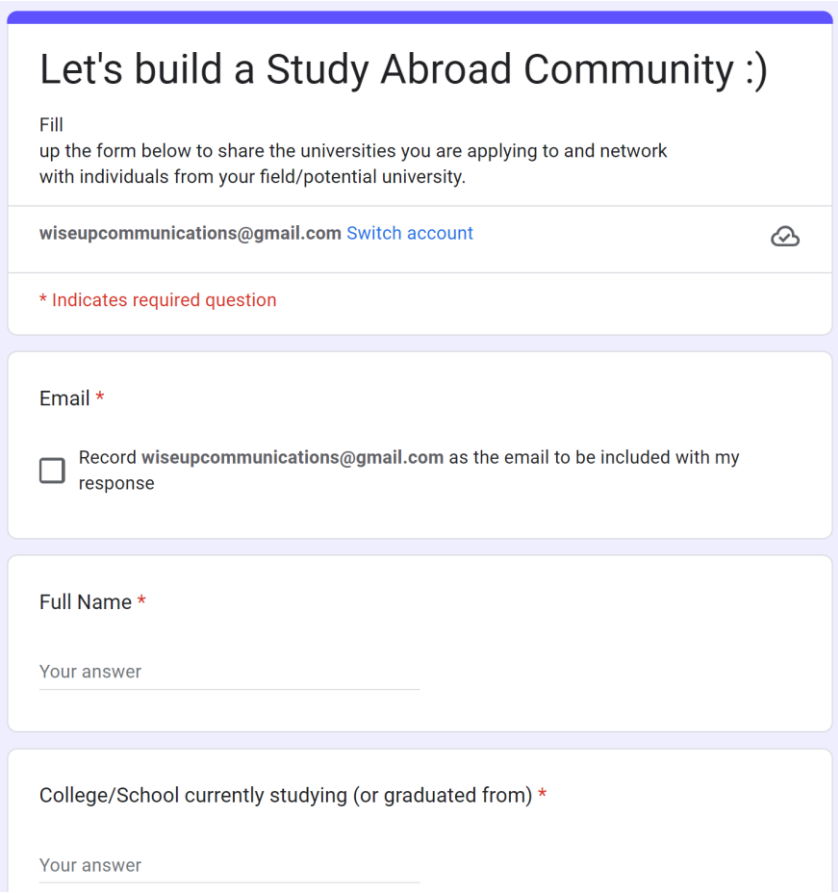
LET’S BUILD A COMMUNITY

Fill up the Google Form to share the universities you are applying to and network with individuals from your field/potential university.



Let's build a Study Abroad Community :)

Fill
up the form below to share the universities you are applying to and network with individuals from your field/potential university.

wiseupcommunications@gmail.com Switch account

* Indicates required question

Email *

Record wiseupcommunications@gmail.com as the email to be included with my response

Full Name *

Your answer

College/School currently studying (or graduated from) *

Your answer

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SET UP FOR SUCCESS

Deliverable 1
Understand the entire study abroad process

Deliverable 2
Learn the purpose and outline of SOP writing

Deliverable 3
Learn the step-by-step approach to SOP writing (with examples)

Deliverable 4
Receive multiple sample SOPs, and other admission essays

Deliverable 5
Learn to write SOP for MBA and undergraduate programs

Deliverable 6
Learn how to write personal statements & scholarship essays

Deliverable 7
Learn how to write LORs and emails to professors

Deliverable 8
Put your learning in the writing for success

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UNDERSTAND THE STUDY ABROAD PROCESS

Choose your universities

Follow the study abroad timeline

Know types of admission essays needed

Steps to write an admission essay

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CHOOSE YOUR UNIVERSITIES

1

Choose the country

Shortlist the country/countries you would like to apply to based on the following:

- ✓ Job opportunities
- ✓ Scholarship options
- ✓ Tuition fees
- ✓ Ease of getting a visa
- ✓ Language requirement
- ✓ Long-term settling options

2

Check university ranking lists

Get a rough idea of the universities by going through popular rankings:

- ✓ QS World University rankings
- ✓ Times Higher Education rankings
- ✓ US News (for US only)

Overall, aim for top 200-250 universities in the world.

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CHOOSE YOUR UNIVERSITIES

3

Use AI tools/websites

Get a rough estimate of university-profile fit by using some AI tools and websites:

- ✓ ChatGPT (prompts like GRE cut-offs, GPA cut-offs etc.)
- ✓ Leverage Edu AI course finder
- ✓ Niche.com Admissions Calculator (for undergrad programs)

4

Use LinkedIn (important)

Check the universities your school/college alumni secured admission in:

- ✓ Gives a good understanding of your chances
- ✓ Reach out to gain more clarity about their profile and overall study abroad process

CHOOSE YOUR UNIVERSITIES

5

Visit university websites

With some clarity on universities, check individual university websites for:

- ✓ GRE/TOEFL/IELTS/GPA cut-offs
- ✓ Course curriculum
- ✓ Research areas
- ✓ Upcoming meets with admission's office
- ✓ Can use ChatGPT/QS University Search for more targeted questions

6

Categorize universities

Choose at least 8-10 universities to give yourself a good chance. Categorize them into:

- ✓ Ambitious – Difficult to get in
- ✓ Moderate – 50-50 chance
- ✓ Safe – Most likely to get in

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FOLLOW THE STUDY ABROAD TIMELINE

March – April (PY)

Finalize the universities

Make a list of 8-10 universities you would apply to and check for CGPA, GRE, TOEFL/IELTS cut-offs

May – July (PY)

Give admission tests

Prepare and complete the admission tests like GRE, GMAT, TOEFL/ IELTS, etc.

Aug – Sept (PY)

Write admission essays

Write and finalize all your admission essays like SOP, LORs, PS, research proposal, CV etc.

Sept-Oct (PY)

Send email to professors

For research-based programs only, send emails to professors enquiring about open research positions

*PY – Previous Year, AY – Admission Year

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FOLLOW THE STUDY ABROAD TIMELINE

October (PY)

Create university accounts

Create account on the university portals, go through the entire application form and fill personal particulars

Nov (PY) – Feb (AY)

Send applications

Based on the deadlines, start sending out applications one-by-one. Do not wait till the last day.

Feb – Apr (AY)

Application evaluation

Committee shortlists applicants based on fit, overall standing in the pool of applicants, and unique circumstances

April – June (AY)

Receive admission offers

The admission offers will start flowing in. Make sure to weigh your options and make the best decision :)

*PY – Previous Year, AY – Admission Year

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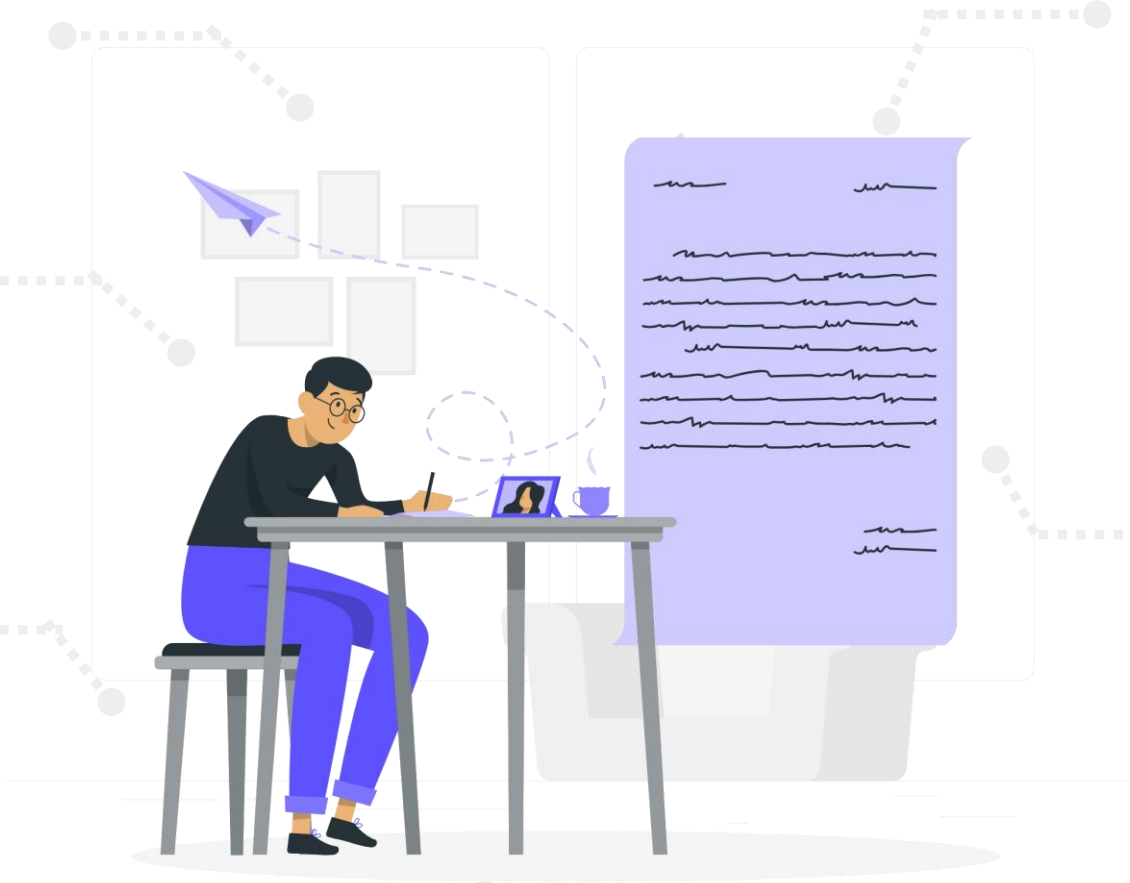
KNOW THE TYPE OF ADMISSION ESSAYS

7. Letters of Recommendation (LORs)
Atleast 2-3 per university

6. Research Proposal
Required by some research-based programs like MS/PhD

5. Curriculum Vitae (CV)
A CV is a must for every university. Don't just focus on the essays. Make sure you have a professional CV.



1. 1000-word SOP
Most common essay required. If universities don't specify a word-limit, go for this length

2. 500-word SOP
Some universities ask for this SOP. Don't cut down a 1000-word SOP into 500 words. Write afresh.

4. Specific university questions
Many universities now ask answers to questions instead of full SOPs.
Needed to be attempted individually.

3. 500-word Personal Statement/ Scholarship Essay
Focuses on personal experiences or essay-prompts given by the university.

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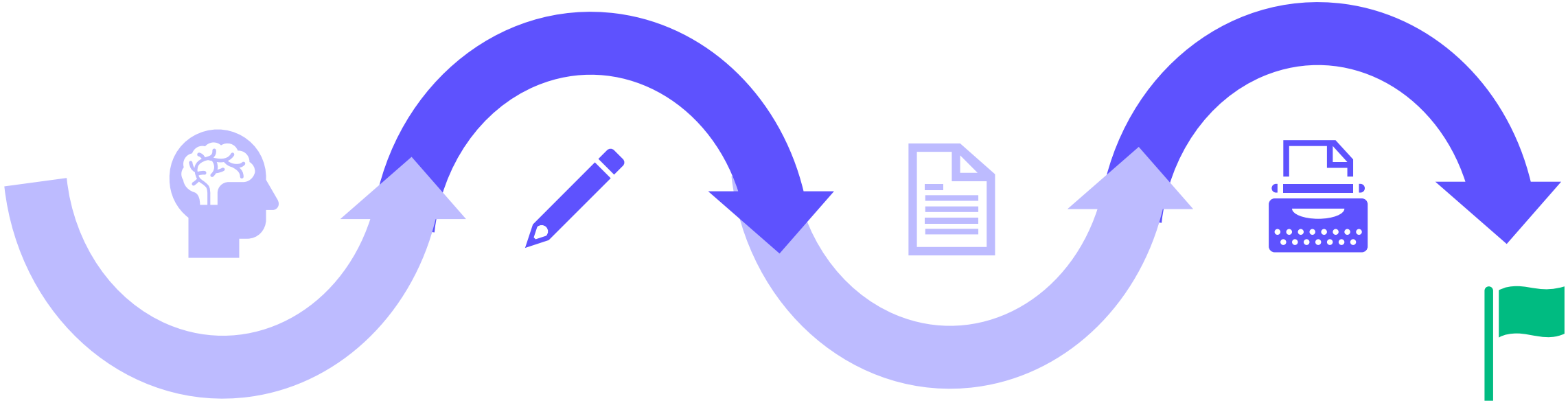
STEPS TO WRITING AN ADMISSION ESSAY

02 WORD-VOMITING

Write down your thoughts on a piece of paper. Don't worry about flow, language etc.

04 REVIEWING

Once finalized, get your document reviewed from friends/experts for feedback



01 BRAINSTORMING

Think of a convincing story line with key points before you start writing your essay

03 DRAFTING

Use your word-vomit draft and polish it for language, flow, words

After incorporating the suggestions, essay should be ready for submission

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END OF SESSION 1